25900584 MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025

Third SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG3DSCPSY200 – FOUNDATIONS OF PSYCHOLOGY

Duration: 1 Hour 30 Minutes (2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS) Maximum Marks: 50

Part A Multiple Choice Questions

Answer all questions.Each question carries 1 marks

1. Phenomenon where we fail to attend to continuous unchanging stimulus is called [K]/ [CO1]

a). Habituation

2.According to Maslow,People [U]/[CO2]

b). have a natural tendency to self-actualization

3. According to Rasa theory, "Karuna Rasa" represents [U]/[CO3]

c). Sorrow

4. Research has shown that the span of attention is greater for which type of stimuli? [K]/ [CO1]

d).Meaningful words

5. Which factor most likely increases external validity in field experiments compared to laboratory experiments? [U]/ [CO1]

b).Naturalistic setting of participant behaviour

6. The strength of survey research lies in [U]/ [CO1]

a).Ability to collect large-scale data

7. Horney believed that most neuroses are the result of [K] / [CO2]

a). Unhealthy interpersonal relations.

8. If a person eats even when not hungry due to stress , this indicates [An] / [CO3]

b). Secondary Motive influenced by social/psychological factors

9. An example of correlational research is [U]/[CO1]

c).Measuring the link between stress and academic performance children

10. In which case is the scientific approach of psychology most clearly demonstrated? [U]/ [CO1]

b) A researcher uses controlled experiments and replicable methods

[1x10 = 10]

Part B

Short Essay Questions.Answer any 2 questions.Each question carries 5 marks

11. Explain the top- down and bottom up processes in perception. [K]/ [CO1]

In bottom-up processing, we start constructing at the "bottom," with raw materials. That is, we begin with small sensory units (features), and build upward to a complete perception.. If readers depended exclusively on bottom-up processing, they would have to analyse the features of letters in words to recognize them and then assemble the letters into words. This task would be terribly time-consuming and would slow down reading speed to a snail's pace.

In top-down processing, preexisting knowledge is used to rapidly organize features into a meaningful whole (Goldstein, 2007). Top-down processing the use of pre-existing knowledge to organize individual features into a unified whole. This is also a form of perceptual expectancy . Fortunately, the two types of processing are often used together in perceiving the surrounding world .Feature analysis assumes that form perception involves bottom-up processing, a progression from individual elements to the whole , top-down processing, a progression from the whole to the elements.

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12. Compare ancient typologies (Indian and Greek) in terms of how they explained personality. [U]/[CO2]

Triguna:Three Principles of Creation according to ayurveda**:**Prakriti (nature) has three primary constituents, the three gunas: tamas (inertia), rajas (activity), and sattva (clarity or light).. Every individual balances these three qualities, although most people are dominated by one of them. The three gunas are always found together, like three strands of intertwined rope

William H. Sheldon postulated three body types which called **somatotypes** Each body type was presumed to be dominated by one of three tissue layers of the body. Sheldon called the first type the endomorph .Second are mesomorphs and third body type the ectomorph.

Hippocrates expanded on the contemporary Greek notion that the world consists of four elements: earth, wind, fire, and water. He proposed that human beings also are composed of four distinct life forces or elemental fluids, which he defined as blood, phlegm, yellow bile, and black bile. **Galen**, extended the Hippocratic theory of humors to explain differences in human temperament. Thus, if blood became thepredominant humor in a person's constitution, he or she would be sanguine—Individual with too much phlegm, would become phlegmatic—. Similarly, an oversupply of yellow bile would lead to a choleric or angry temperament, and too much black bile would produce a melancholy or depressed personality.

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13. Differentiate Maslow's self-actualization and Self-determination theory's concept of autonomy. [An]/ [CO3]

Abraham Maslow proposed the **hierarchy of needs**, suggesting that human motivation progresses from **basic physiological and safety needs** to **love/belonging, esteem,** and finally **self-actualization**. The lower four levels are **deficiency needs**, activated by lack, while **self-actualization** represents a **growth need** driven by personal development.

Ryan and Deci's **Self-Determination Theory (SDT)** complements Maslow's model, emphasizing three innate needs—**autonomy, competence, and relatedness**—which, when fulfilled in a supportive environment, enhance **intrinsic motivation** According to **Maslow**, autonomy is one of the **meta-needs** of self-actualizing individuals, representing **self-sufficiency** and independence from external pressures. Self-actualized people act according to their **inner values** rather than social expectations.In **Self-Determination Theory (Ryan & Deci, 2000)**, autonomy is one of the three **basic psychological needs**—along with competence and relatedness—that foster **intrinsic motivation** and psychological growth. When individuals experience autonomy, they feel their actions are **self-determined**, which enhances motivation, creativity, and overall well-being.

[5×2 = 10]

Part C Essay.Answer any 2 questions Each question carries 15 marks

14. Describe Freud's psychosexual stages of development, highlighting the main characteristics of each stage. [U]/[CO2]

Freud theorized that the core of personality is formed before age 6 in a series of **psychosexual stages.** Freud believed that erotic urges in childhood have lasting effects on development. At each stage, a different part of the body becomes a child's primary **erogenous zone** (an area capable of producing pleasure). Each area then serves as the main source of pleasure, frustration, and selfexpression. Freud believed that many adult personality traits can be traced to **fixations** in one or more of the stages. A fixation is an unresolved conflict or emotional hangup caused by overindulgence or by frustration
Oral Stage (1-18 months, **erogenous zone**: mouth, **primary conflict**: weaning, **fixation**: **oral-dependent personality** , **oralaggressive** adults who exploit others. overeating, smoking, nail biting, drinking, chewing gums)**.**
Anal Stage (18-36 months, **erogenous zone**:anus, **source of conflict**: toilet training,**fixation:** anal explusive and anal retentive personality. Freud described the **anal-retentive** (holding-on) **personality** as obstinate, stingy, orderly, and compulsively clean. The **anal-expulsive** (letting-go) **personality** is disorderly, destructive, cruel, or messy.)**.**
Phallic Stage (3-6 years, child discovers sexual feelings, Oedipus Complex, Electra Complex. **Fixation:** immature sexual attitudes)**.**
Latency Stage (6years-puberty, during school years, sexual feelings are repressed while the child develops in other ways, Child grow intellectually and physically)**.**
Genital Stage (starts from puberty, sexual urges enters consciousness but parents are not targets, individual move towards social and other adults, sexual behaviour).

15. Compare incentive theory and Self determination theory of motivation. [An]/ [CO3]

The "pull" of a goal is called its **incentive value** (the goal's appeal beyond its ability to fill a need). Some goals are so desirable (strawberry pie, for example) that they can motivate behavior in the absence of an internal need. Incentive theories propose that external stimuli regulate motivational states (Bolles, 1975; McClelland, 1975; Skinner, 1953). **An *incentive* is an external goal that has the capacity to motivate behavior** Incentive theories emphasize how *external* stimuli *pull* people in certain directions. According to incentive theories, the source of motivation lies *outside* the organism, in the environment. This means that incentive models don't operate according to the principle of homeostasis, incentive theories emphasize environmental factors and downplay the biological bases of human motivation.

Self determination theory (SDT) of Ryan and Deci (2000)there are three inborn and universal needs are **autonomy**, or the need to be in control of one's own behavior and goals (i.e., self-determination); **competence,** or the need to be able to master the challenging tasks of one's life; and **relatedness**, or the need to feel a sense of belonging, intimacy, and security in relationships with others. Satisfying these needs can best be accomplished if the person has a supportive environment in which to develop goals and relationships with others. Such satisfaction will not only foster healthy psychological growth but also increase the individual's intrinsic motivation (actions are performed because they are internally rewarding or satisfying). Evidence suggests that intrinsic motivation is increased or enhanced when a person not only feels competence (through experiencing positive feedback from others and succeeding at what are perceived to be challenging tasks) but also a sense of autonomy or the knowledge that his or her actions are self-determined rather than controlled by others

16. Discuss how different psychological methods complement each other in achieving the goals of psychology. [U]/ [CO1]

Different psychological methods complement each other in achieving the **goals of psychology**—namely **description, explanation, prediction, and control** of behavior.

The **experimental method** helps establish cause-and-effect relationships by manipulating variables under controlled conditions. The **observational method** allows researchers to describe behavior as it occurs naturally, providing real-life insights. **Survey and interview methods** gather large amounts of data on attitudes, opinions, and behaviors, supporting generalization. The **case study method** offers in-depth understanding of individual behavior, especially in rare or unique situations. **Correlational studies** reveal relationships between variables, aiding prediction, even though they do not show causation.

[15×2 = 30]